Tier pack: Independent route — Critique, test and redirect the design

Pathway: TRACK · Week 4 Part 2 · Big question: How do we use a structured studio critique to spot a weak area and test one material fix?

Independent route studio steps

Step 1: Pair up for a two-minute stand-up critique using the 'Strength / Target / Test' protocol.

Step 2: Create a 6 cm material swatch testing a structural or tonal improvement (lamination depth, oxide patina, or flange highlight).

Step 3: Apply the successful modification directly to your architectural relief panel.

Step 4: Mount the swatch in your studio log with a three-line annotation explaining why the change improved visual impact.

Success check

Peer critique recorded, swatch tested and mounted, main panel upgraded and annotated.

Key words helper

• critique: A structured studio check that identifies strengths and specific next steps.

• diagnostic: Spotting the exact visual or structural reason why an area looks weak.

• redirect: Adjusting your plan or adding a layer to solve a design problem.

• swatch: A small test piece used to try a fix before putting it on your main artwork.

• focal joint: The main structural intersection where beams meet and draw the eye.

Review checklist

[ ] Place your upgraded panel next to your mounted swatch to verify the improvement.

[ ] Thank your critique partner for their diagnostic feedback.

[ ] Store your panel safely for final resolution.